

Development Workflow Differences with PWA Kit

PWA Kit uses a traditional Webpack-based development server with configuration spread across multiple files. Storefront Next leverages Vite for faster development with native ESM, instant HMR, and type-safe configuration. The shift to Vite provides a more modern developer experience with faster feedback loops and better tooling integration.

Key Differences

Aspect	PWA Kit	Storefront Next
Dev Server	Webpack Dev Server	Vite Dev Server
CLI Tool	<code>pwa-kit-dev start</code>	<code>sfnext dev</code>
HMR	Webpack HMR	Vite native HMR
Config Format	JavaScript	TypeScript
Env Vars	Standard .env	Typed with <code>PUBLIC_</code> prefix
Testing	Jest	Vitest
Type Safety	Optional	Required

Key Similarities

1. Port conventions: Both can run on any port.
2. API proxy pattern: Both use `/mobify/proxy/` path.
3. Environment variables: Both support .env files.
4. Node.js debugging: Both support `--inspect` flag.

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Considerations

1. Port Change

- Update any hardcoded port references from 3000 to 5173.
- Or configure Vite to use port 3000.

2. Environment Variables

- Convert standard env vars to `PUBLIC_` prefix format.
- Update `.env` files with new naming convention.

3. Config Migration

- Convert `config/default.js` to `config.server.ts`.
- Add TypeScript types for configuration.

4. Testing Migration

- Convert Jest tests to Vitest.
- Update test configuration files.

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